

Oregon State University
College of Health
H524 Introduction to Biostatistics
Fall 2025

Credit Hours: 04

Schedule:

Lecture: Monday, Wednesday 12:00-1:20pm (CORD 1424)
Lab: Wednesday: 8:00 am – 9:50 am (BEXL 323)

Course Instructor: Dr. John Molitor

Office Location: 153 Milam

Office Phone: 541-737-3834

E-Mail: john.molitor@oregonstate.edu

Instructor Communication: Available via Canvas messaging and via Zoom.

Office Hours: Wednesdays 10:00–11:30am (153 Milam or via Zoom)

Office hours are scheduled to accommodate diverse student schedules, and I am very flexible about meeting either in person or via Zoom with an appointment. This approach has worked well in previous classes I teach. Additionally, lab time (Wednesday 8:00–9:50am) is an excellent opportunity to ask questions. As with other classes I teach, there will be one dedicated office hours day during Week 9 (in lieu of formal lecture) so that everyone can attend.

Course Description:

Quantitative analysis and interpretation of health data including probability distributions, estimation of associations, and significance tests such as chi-squared, one-way ANOVA, and linear regression.

AI-Enhanced Component: This course integrates generative AI tools as learning partners for statistical analysis. Students will learn to leverage AI for code generation, concept explanation, and problem-solving while developing critical skills in output verification and responsible AI use.

Academic Calendar

All students are subject to the registration and refund deadlines as stated in the Academic Calendar: <https://registrar.oregonstate.edu/osu-academic-calendar>

Expectations for Time and Participation

This course combines approximately 120 total hours of instruction, online activities, and assignments for 4 credits.

Prerequisites

H 524 assumes basic knowledge of statistical concepts and procedures equivalent to that of an undergraduate statistics course, and MTH 105 (Introduction to Contemporary Mathematics) or MTH 111 (College Algebra) or a higher mathematics course.

Learning Resources

Resources include, but are not limited to:

- Lecture Notes
- Reading Assignments
- Discussions in class and on Canvas

- Problem Sets
- In-office help during office hours from both course instructor and lab instructors
- **AI Tools:** Microsoft Copilot (required); GitHub Copilot with RStudio (optional but recommended)
- **AI Prompt Templates:** Curated prompts for statistical analysis tasks

Textbook

Principles of Biostatistics, 2nd edition, 2022

Marcello Pagano and Kimberlee Gauvreau

Measurable Student Learning Outcomes

- Select and generate graphical and numerical summaries of data.
- Use principles of statistical inference to make conclusions about populations from samples.
- Communicate statistical findings to others.
- Use computer software to conduct statistical analysis.
 - *AI Integration: Effectively prompt AI tools for statistical tasks and critically evaluate their outputs.*
 - *Verification Skills: Validate AI-generated code and results through independent checking.*

Evaluation of Student Performance

Grading: Tests will be graded according to the following scale. It is possible, however, that adjustments will be made to this scale based on class performance.

Range	Grade
94–100%	A
89–93	A-
84–88	B+
79–83	B
74–78	B-
69–73	C+
64–68	C
59–63	C-
54–58	D+
49–53	D
44–48	D-
Less than 44	F

Grading Components

Component	Weight
Weekly Assignments	60%
Group Project	25%
Class Participation	15%

Assignments

Weekly assignments will be given throughout the semester and will include [AI-enhanced components](#).

Group Project

A final group project will serve as the culminating assessment for the course.

AI Use Policy

Permitted AI Use:

- Microsoft Copilot is required for concept exploration; GitHub Copilot (with RStudio) is recommended for code generation
- All AI-generated content must be verified
- Students must demonstrate understanding independent of AI assistance

Course Schedule

The proposed schedule is subject to change by the instructor. What follows is a general outline of the proposed topics for discussion as well as the proposed dates. However, if we run out of time, get in a particularly lengthy discussion, or cover a topic more quickly than expected, there will likely be changes to the syllabus.

Week	Topic	Reading Assignment
Week 0:	Introduction to R Data Presentation Numerical Summary Measures	Pagano: Chapters 1, 2, 3
Week 1:	Introduction to R Data Presentation Numerical Summary Measures Rates and Standardization	Pagano: Chapters 1, 2, 3, 4
Week 2:	Probability	Pagano: Chapter 6 (6.1–6.4.2, 6.5)
Week 3:	Theoretical Probability Distributions Sampling Distribution of the Mean	Pagano: Chapter 7 (7.1, 7.2, 7.4), and 8
Week 4:	Confidence Intervals	Pagano: Chapter 9
Week 5:	Hypothesis Testing	Pagano: Chapter 10
Week 6:	Power Comparison of Two Means Analysis of Variance	Pagano: Chapter 11, 12
Week 7:	Nonparametric Methods	Pagano: Chapter 13
Week 8:	Catch-up from Weeks 6 & 7 Contingency Tables Multiple Contingency Tables	Pagano: Chapters 15, 16
Week 9:	Correlation Simple Linear Regression	Pagano: Chapters 17, 18
Week 10:	Group Project Final Presentations Simple Linear Regression	Pagano: Chapter 18

Lab Sessions - AI Integration

Wednesday labs will include:

- Traditional R programming exercises
- **AI-Enhanced Activities**

Assessment Philosophy

This course emphasizes continuous learning and practical application over high-stakes testing. Assessment focuses on:

- Regular homework assignments that build statistical competency
- Collaborative learning through group projects
- AI tool integration and documentation skills
- Professional communication and presentation abilities

Diversity Statement

The College of Public Health and Human Sciences strives to create an affirming climate for all students including underrepresented and marginalized individuals and groups. Diversity encompasses differences in age, color, ethnicity, national origin, gender, physical or mental ability, religion, socioeconomic background, veteran status, sexual orientation, and marginalized groups. We believe diversity is the synergy, connection, acceptance, and mutual learning fostered by the interaction of different human characteristics.

Expectations for Student Conduct

The Student Conduct Code establishes community standards and procedures necessary to maintain and protect an environment conducive to learning, in keeping with the educational objectives of Oregon State University. This code is based on the assumption that all persons must treat one another with dignity and respect in order for scholarship to thrive. For the full Student Conduct Code see http://studentlife.oregonstate.edu/sites/studentlife.oregonstate.edu/files/code_of_student_conduct.pdf

Academic or Scholarly Dishonesty is prohibited and considered a serious violation of the Student Conduct Code. It is defined as an act of deception in which a Student seeks to claim credit for the work or effort of another person, or uses unauthorized materials or fabricated information in any academic work or research, either through the Student's own efforts or the efforts of another. For specifics related to offenses proscribed by the University see: <http://oregonstate.edu/studentconduct/offenses-0>

Religious Holiday Statement

Oregon State University strives to respect all religious practices. If you have religious holidays that are in conflict with any of the requirements of this class, please see me immediately so that we can make alternative arrangements.

Students with Documented Disabilities

Accommodations for students with disabilities are determined and approved by Disability Access Services (DAS). If you, as a student, believe you are eligible for accommodations but have not obtained approval please contact DAS immediately at 541-737-4098 or at <http://ds.oregonstate.edu>. DAS notifies students and faculty members of approved academic accommodations and coordinates implementation of those accommodations. While not required, students and faculty members are encouraged to discuss details of the implementation of individual accommodations.